DEPUTY SECRETARY OF WAR
1010 DEFENSE PENTAGON
WASHINGTON, DC 20301-1010

OCT 05 2026

MEMORANDUM FOR SENIOR PENTAGON LEADERSHIP
COMMANDERS OF THE COMBATANT COMMANDS
DEFENSE AGENCY AND DOW FIELD ACTIVITY DIRECTORS

SUBJECT: Overhauling the Department of War's Security Classification Lifecycle with Artificial Intelligence and Designating the Secretary of the Air Force as the Executive Agent for Automated Classification Management Environment

Outdated procedures for the classification and declassification of documents and data are endangering the DoW's ability to achieve its mission. The dysfunction caused by these procedures leads to incorrect classifications that burden our national security systems, impede interoperability, and slows innovation by trapping vital data in stovepipes. These outdated procedures delay declassification, which obstructs the timely release of critical information and erodes public trust in the DoW's commitment to transparency and accountability in national security.

Effective immediately, in accordance with DoD Directive (DoDD) 5101.01, DoD Executive Agent (EA), I hereby appoint the Secretary of the Air Force to serve as the DoW EA for Automated Classification Management Environment (ACME) — a suite of artificial intelligence-aided tools created by the Department of the Air Force to modernize the Department's security classification processes and its management of sensitive information. The DoW EA shall execute an initial small-scale deployment of an automated security classification capability within 180 days of the date of this memorandum. Upon successful pilot outcomes, this capability will eventually serve as the single, digital authoritative reference for all DoW original classification decisions. The Under Secretary of War for Intelligence and Security (USW(I&S)), as the Secretary of War's Principal Staff Assistant for security in accordance with DoD Directive 5143.01, is responsible for oversight of the DoW EA for ACME, supported by the DoW Chief Information Officer (DoW CIO) for technical scalability and cyber security considerations.

I direct the USW(I&S) to take immediate action, in coordination with the Under Secretary of War for Research and Engineering and the DoW CIO, to support the technical solutions to modernize classification and declassification procedures across the information security lifecycle. These technical solutions should include, but not be limited to, solutions developed within the scope of ACME. The USW(I&S) shall also publish and revise policies to enable this modernization.

OSD007958-26/CMD010252-26